Open it. Print it. Teach it.

45-minute lesson | Grades 8-12 | Business, economics, entrepreneurship

The job students are doing

Students choose a selling price and inventory level for four afternoons. They calculate profit, explain unsold inventory, and distinguish a change in price from a change in demand. The game uses fixed scenarios, so every result has a checkable answer.

Before class

1. Open Last_Bell.html in a desktop browser. Click How to play, then run one test round. No account or installation is needed.

2. Print Student_Sheets.pdf, two pages per student (double-sided works). For less copying, use one page 1 per team and one page 2 per student.

3. Put students in groups of 2-4; select 1-8 teams. Use only team letters on the screen. Students need a pencil and a basic calculator.

4. If downloaded HTML is blocked, open Projector_Deck.pdf. It contains all forecasts and demand reveals for a complete paper lesson.

Minutes	Teacher	Students
0-5	Set up teams; explain the goal	Read the rules
5-9	Work the example on page 2	Check revenue vs. profit
9-33	Run four six-minute rounds	Choose, calculate, explain
33-40	Compare two final-round results	Defend one change
40-45	Collect the individual exit ticket	Complete items 4 and 5

Aim for sound reasoning, not the highest score. The weather and crowd information is incomplete before the reveal. A sensible choice can still lose to a lucky one.

Rules that prevent confusion.

A fresh day each round.

Each team has a new $100 spending limit. Cash and inventory do not carry forward. Only profit adds to the four-day score. Every listed choice fits the budget.

Teams have separate customers.

Treat each team as an identical stand in a separate location. They do not share or take customers from each other. Do not introduce bidding or price competition.

Count every cost.

Pay for all stocked drinks, even unsold ones, plus the $10 stand fee. Unit cost is $1 in rounds 1-3 and $1.50 in round 4. Prepared drinks have no salvage value.

Commit before the reveal.

Give everyone 30 seconds of individual thinking, then 90 seconds to agree. Record all choices on paper before entering them. This prevents copying a revealed outcome.

Keep grades separate from luck.

Have the reader read the forecast, the recorder enter choices, and the checker verify arithmetic. Rotate roles; in pairs, combine reader and recorder.

Work this example together

At a $3 price, stock 30 drinks costing $1 each. Demand turns out to be 28. Sold = 28. Revenue = 28 x $3 = $84. All costs = 30 x $1 + $10 = $40. Profit = $44. Unsold = 2 drinks.

SAY: "We paid for 30 drinks. We sold only 28. The two unsold drinks still belong in our costs."

Every possible profit.

Teacher reference. Do not reveal a round until all choices are locked.

Round 1 / An ordinary afternoon

Unit cost $1 + $10 stand fee. Demand at $2 / $3 / $4: 38 / 28 / 18.

Selling price	Stock 20	Stock 30	Stock 40
$2	$10	$20	$26
$3	$30	$44	$34
$4	$42	$32	$22

Round 2 / The hot afternoon

Unit cost $1 + $10 stand fee. Demand at $2 / $3 / $4: 48 / 38 / 28.

Selling price	Stock 20	Stock 30	Stock 40
$2	$10	$20	$30
$3	$30	$50	$64
$4	$50	$72	$62

Round 3 / The quiet afternoon

Unit cost $1 + $10 stand fee. Demand at $2 / $3 / $4: 28 / 18 / 8.

Selling price	Stock 20	Stock 30	Stock 40
$2	$10	$16	$6
$3	$24	$14	$4
$4	$2	$-8	$-18

Round 4 / The big game

Unit cost $1.50 + $10 stand fee. Demand at $2 / $3 / $4: 50 / 38 / 26.

Selling price	Stock 20	Stock 30	Stock 40
$2	$0	$5	$10
$3	$20	$35	$44
$4	$40	$49	$34

Best profits in hindsight: $44, $72, $24, $49 (total $189). Do not grade students on this target.

What good answers sound like.

1 / Waste and stockouts

Accept an accurate count and a reasonable tradeoff. Example: in Round 2 at $3 with 30 drinks, demand is 38, so 8 purchases go unfilled. Stocking 40 would serve those buyers but risk more waste if the crowd were smaller.

2 / Revenue is not profit

Round 4: $3 and 40 drinks produces $114 revenue, $70 costs, and $44 profit. $4 and 30 drinks produces $104 revenue, $55 costs, and $49 profit. The second stand has $10 less revenue but $5 more profit.

3 / Demand shift versus price change

Heat increased demand at each listed price. A seller lowering its own price moves along the same demand schedule; the hotter weather changes the schedule. Do not call a change in the seller's price a demand shift.

4 / Exit-ticket arithmetic

Revenue: 24 x $3 = $72. Costs: 30 x $1.50 + $10 = $55. Profit: $17. Unsold: 6 drinks. Charging more per sale is not the same as earning more overall.

5 / Opportunity cost

The next-best alternative is stocking 20 drinks and retaining the cash not spent on the extra 10. Accept an explanation of that single forgone option. It is not the sum of every alternative and is not automatically equal to the cash expense.

Suggested 20-point check

Decision record: 4 points for four reasoned choices. Ledger: 8 points, two per accurate round (allow corrected work). Explanations 1-3: 3 points. Exit ticket 4: 4 points, one per value. Opportunity cost: 1 point. Do not award points for beating another team.

When the classroom changes.

No devices / blocked files

Use the Projector Deck or read each forecast from it. Students lock choices. Reveal only that round's demand. They use calculators; you use the profit tables on page 3. The full lesson still works.

Thirty-minute class

Use rounds 1 and 4 only. Allow 5 minutes for rules, 5 for the worked example, 12 for both rounds, and 8 for comparison and exit ticket. Score two days, not four.

More support

Start with one price ($3) and compare only stock levels. Read each forecast aloud. Pair a student who explains with one who checks. Keep calculators available; provide the worked example.

More challenge

After revealing a round, find the best choice in hindsight and explain why the same choice might fail tomorrow. In Round 4 compare the $114-revenue stand with the $104-revenue stand.

Absent student / independent route

Provide the demand schedules on page 3 after the student predicts an outcome. Use $3 and stock 30 in all four rounds. Ask for the full ledger, then items 2-5 on the student sheet. Expected profits: $44, $50, $14, $35; total $143.

Browser and session notes

The game is a downloaded HTML file, designed for a teacher's desktop browser. Some managed devices block it. Browser saves stay on that device and can be cleared; Save session creates a portable JSON file. Load session restores it. Export results creates an anonymous CSV. The game makes no network requests.

Classroom use

One purchasing educator may use and adapt the files in their own classes and place them in a private class LMS. Do not resell the files or post the full paid product publicly. Follow the marketplace's governing license. Contact the seller through the purchase platform for file problems.